

REVATHI BHASKER, *72*

WHERE **Covai S3 Retirement Community,** *Coimbatore*

MOVED IN **2010**

WHY THEY MOVED
Living alone was tough and getting timely help difficult

"IN SENIOR LIVING COMMUNITIES, EVERYONE IS CONNECTED TOGETHER THROUGH RETIREMENT AND OLD AGE. THE PROBLEMS ARE SIMILAR AND THE EMPATHY, HIGHER"



"Eldercare is often viewed through the lens of disease. The most basic question asked is 'aap theek ho?' (are you okay?). But '*theek ho*' has many dimensions"

SAUMYAJIT ROY, *CEO, Emoha Elder Care*

tor: seniors who are largely independent but require help with daily tasks, seniors with dementia who cannot live alone, transition care for seniors needing post-operative care and rehabilitation, and palliative care for elderly individuals with advanced conditions who choose not to undergo aggressive medical treatments.

Unlike retirement homes that operate on a house ownership model, assisted living spaces work on a rental model, where residents can rent a room. Rental rates at Athulya range from Rs 55,000 to Rs 75,000 and Antara Care Home costs Rs 1.25 to Rs 1.5 lakh per month depending on the property's location, the type of room taken and the services availed.

Among Athulya's residents is 87-year-old Kannan V., who moved to their Chennai facility four years ago after his wife passed away and it became difficult for him to live alone. "No one wants to leave their home," he says, "but for people our age, sometimes it is challenging to get out of bed or even open the door to accept deliveries. That's where assisted living places like this come to our rescue," he says. Kannan finds the call bell system, essentially a public speaker system, extremely useful. He can press it to get trivial tasks done, such as requesting a hot water bottle or reporting an emergency. "Assistance arrives within minutes," he says. He also takes advantage of their escort services when he visits the doctor or the bank, for a minimal charge of Rs 100 per hour.

While Kannan is at Athulya for a longer duration, 68-year-old Ratna Ghosh, a former government school teacher, chose Antara Care Home in Gurugram for post-hospitalisation recovery. "I have lung and heart issues as well as hypertension, so I needed full care with constant monitoring of my vitals, dietary requirements and assistance with movement, which was not possible at home," she says. At home, there was always someone seeking her attention. Being away from home allows her to focus solely on her recovery.

Home Healthcare

Services in this segment account for around 40 per cent of the eldercare market, as estimated by PwC India. Offering such services are top hospitals, including Apollo, Medanta, Sir Ganga Ram, and home care providers like Portea Medical, Medrabbits and HCAH. They cater to consumers across all age groups, including seniors. Then, there are home care providers specifically targeting the elderly. Among them are Emoha, ElderAid and Samarth. Making a start with offering clinical services, such as home attendants, nurses, physiotherapy, lab collections, and even ICU set-ups at home, over time, they have expanded their services to include